

EEF Meeting Minutes, Thursday June 25, 2020

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation, Minutes of a Regular Meeting of the Board of Directors Meeting #31, June 25, 2020

A regular meeting of the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation was held over group conference call (Zoom). The meeting began at 16:07 UTC.

Attendance

The following members of the board of directors were present (7/11): Francesco Cesarini, Benoît Chesneau, Peer Stritzinger, Sebastian Strollo, Frédéric Trottier-Hébert, Miriam Pena Villanueva, and Alistair Woodman.

Agenda Items

1. Vote of the minutes of the previous meeting.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the minutes as presented as representing a true and accurate record of the board meeting #30 held on June 11, 2020. Unanimously approved.

2. Intermediate actions:

1. Alistair and Sebastian had a meeting with the foundation group on June 17 regarding help with filing our taxes.
3. Treasury and membership update: \$170k in the bank. Membership numbers: Basic: 437, Annual Supporting: 97, Lifetime Supporting: 9.
4. SpawnFest. Fred and Francesco explained what SpawnFest is (an annual 48 hour free online development competition in which teams from around the world get exactly one weekend to create the best BEAM-based applications they can) and that SpawnFest seeks sponsorship in whatever form we can provide. Preferred type of sponsorship are things that can be given out as prizes (preferably not cash). It was suggested that the board approve the marketing working group to spend up to a \$1000 in a suitable way to sponsor SpawnFest.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve spending up to a \$1000 on sponsoring SpawnFest. Unanimously approved.

5. Google Summer of Code update: Students will report in two weeks. Sebastian will set up Payoneer account (as per instructions from Google) to receive the mentor money.
6. Proposal from Susumu Yamazaki to form an “External Process Communication, Interface and Robustness” (full proposal attached to the meeting minutes). After a short discussion (around technical merits and what the working group was going to do) the board agreed that it did not fit in an existing working group and it is better to include new working groups into the community, which should give them more opportunity to refine the work they want to do.

RESOLVED, that the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation approve the forming of the External Process Communication, Interface and Robustness Working Group. Vote count: Benoit abstained, no objections, 6 in favor.

7. Peer presented how the Embedded Working Group is trying to get a bounty like program off the ground (diagrams attached at the end of the minutes). By formalizing the process of how the EWG is collecting and sorting proposals they hope to be able to get enough proposals up to a point where they can be implemented (and also set a bounty price on the proposals). Peer presented this as a suggestion on how to get us to spend money on actual projects that working groups want to do.
8. Annual General Meeting. According to the bylaws we need to hold an Annual Meeting “at which the members shall elect a Board of Directors and transact other proper business”. The election has already been transacted virtually, which leaves the “rest”. There was a discussion around what type of meeting it should be (“a small formal thing” or “an event”) as well as whether to have two meetings (to cover as many time zones as possible). Alistair will keep working on proposal on how to realize the AGM.
9. Alistair declared the meeting adjourned at 17:03 UTC.

Dated June 25, 2020

Secretary of the meeting: _____ Sebastian Strollo

Working Group Proposal, received from Susumu Yamazaki <zacky1972@gmail.com> on June 4, 2020.

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation -- Working Group Proposal

Working Group Name

External Process Communication, Interface and Robustness

Mission Statement

The mission of the working group is to facilitate a seamless interface for interacting with external processes from the Erlang Runtime. An external process is usually used for the purpose to realize efficiency and/or extendability, which cannot be realized by Erlang VM, alone. There are two ways to handle it: Ports and NIFs. Ports are more safe and robust than NIFs due to protection by an UNIX process. On the other hand, NIFs have potential to be more efficient than Ports, though they are required to realize more efficiency and robustness for high performance computing and/or high speed I/O, e.g. GPUs, FPGAs, networks, SSDs and DBs. As of now, there are several solutions created by our community to solve some of the issues, but there is no generic and conclusive solution which solves all the issues. Objectives of the working group are to explore, experiment and evaluate different approaches, to reduce the community fragmentation and effort, and to propose a few unified approaches.

Benefits to the community

- * Serve as a place to discuss potential approaches and issues;
- * Make libraries which wraps external programs have a clear direction;
- * Make our community avoid duplicate efforts and focus on a few hopeful common solutions

Short term deliverables

- * Hopeful solution prototypes;
- * Extended APIs of Ports and NIFs

Long term deliverables

- * A few portable generic solutions for interacting with external processes, which are more efficient and robust than Ports and NIFs

Why does this group require the Foundation

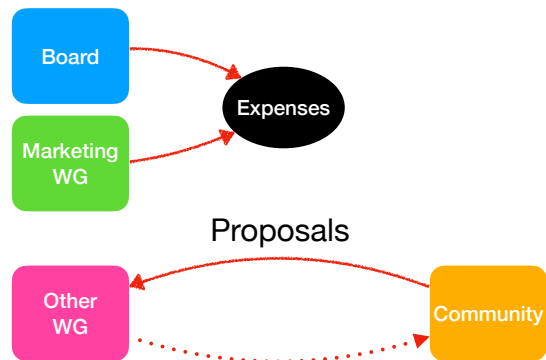
The topics include discussing and exploring different approaches on different platforms. To have a proper integration with Erlang Runtime requires insight and guidance from the core team. This requires backing from the foundation to bring the people together. And the solution has immediate benefit to the community.

Initial list of volunteers

- * Susumu Yamazaki (ZACKY: a co-author of Pelemay <https://github.com/zeam-vm/pelemay>)
- * Akash Hiremath (an author of Exile <https://github.com/akash-akya/exile>)
- * Graham Leva (Software developer at NVIDIA, working on bringing Nerves to NVIDIA's embedded devices)
- * Issac Yonemoto (an author of Zigler <https://github.com/ityonemo/zigler>)
- * Hideki Takase (an author of Cockatrice and RclEx <https://github.com/tlk-emb/rclex>)

Presentation from Peer Stritzinger on how the working group project proposal process could be improved.

Current Process (simplified)



Additional Proposal (simplified)

